

Student Assessment Instructions

CESE323 ERC1.0 - Cloud Security Envisioning & Strategy

Student-facing assessment rules, evidence requirements, submission instructions, and safe lab conduct

Field	Details
Document type	Student assessment administration document
Course code and version	CESE323 ERC1.0
Course title	Cloud Security Envisioning & Strategy
Intended audience	Students and delegates completing the CESE323 knowledge and practical assessments
Assessment mode	Knowledge check, scenario analysis, practical evidence submission, and reflection
Recommended pass mark	70% overall, subject to instructor or training provider policy
Document status	Ready for courseware pack review

Important

This document gives assessment instructions only. It does not contain the assessment questions, answer key, model answers, or instructor marking notes.

Prepared for Skunkworks Academy courseware development

Document Overview

Purpose. These instructions explain how students must complete and submit the CESE323 assessment activities. They cover required deliverables, evidence standards, safe use of Azure and Microsoft Defender for Cloud, academic integrity, marking expectations, and resubmission rules.

Course alignment. The assessment is aligned to the workshop objectives of strategic alignment, unified cloud security visibility, threat reduction, workload hardening, and operational readiness. Assessment tasks should evaluate both conceptual understanding and practical ability to reason about Microsoft Defender for Cloud, CSPM, workload protection, identity, compliance, and AI security scenarios.

Assessment theme	What students must demonstrate
Strategic security alignment	Translate business goals, risks, and compliance priorities into security actions.
CSPM and exposure management	Interpret Secure Score, recommendations, misconfigurations, over-privileged identities, and attack paths.
Workload protection	Explain or evidence protection for selected workloads such as Storage, Containers, App Service, or AI Services.
Threat mitigation and remediation	Map security findings to Microsoft-recommended mitigation actions and operational improvements.
Operational readiness	Provide clean assessment evidence, respect change controls, and complete cleanup or rollback where applicable.

1. Assessment Structure

The CESE323 assessment pack may be delivered as a single end-of-course assessment or as a combination of short assessments throughout the workshop. The recommended structure below supports both instructor-led and self-paced delivery.

Component	Recommended weighting	Format	Student output
A. Knowledge Assessment	30 marks	Multiple-choice, matching, short-answer, and concept-check questions	Completed quiz or LMS submission
B. Practical Lab Evidence	40 marks	Portal-based evidence from Microsoft Defender for Cloud, Azure, Defender portal, or approved simulated environment	Screenshots, notes, resource names, findings, and remediation evidence

C. Scenario Analysis	20 marks	Short written response based on cloud security incident, posture gap, or workload-protection scenario	Structured response with risk, impact, control, and recommendation mapping
D. Reflection and Operational Handover	10 marks	Personal reflection and cleanup/operational-readiness confirmation	Brief reflection, cleanup confirmation, and lessons learned

Instructor discretion

The instructor or training provider may adjust weightings to match the final assessment pack, customer environment, delivery mode, and LMS configuration. Students must follow the weighting and due dates announced for their specific class.

2. Pass Requirements

Result band	Recommended threshold	Meaning
Not yet competent	Below 70%	The submission does not yet demonstrate sufficient knowledge, evidence quality, or operational judgement.
Competent / Pass	70% - 84%	The student demonstrates sound understanding and can apply the concepts safely in a guided environment.
Merit / Strong pass	85% - 94%	The student demonstrates strong reasoning, clear evidence, and practical security decision-making.
Distinction	95% - 100%	The student demonstrates excellent technical accuracy, risk awareness, clarity, and professional operational discipline.

- **Minimum evidence rule:** A student cannot pass on theory alone if practical evidence is required for the class. The practical component must be submitted unless the instructor explicitly approves a demo-only alternative.

- **Safety override:** Unsafe actions in a live tenant, use of sensitive data, unauthorized changes, or failure to follow lab scope may result in the practical component being marked not yet competent.
- **Partial credit:** Marks may be awarded for correct reasoning even when a lab environment blocks a configuration task, provided the student documents the blocker and explains the correct remediation path.

3. Before You Start the Assessment

Students must confirm readiness before starting any assessment activity. Do not wait until the assessment window to test accounts, MFA, tenant selection, permissions, or portal access.

Readiness item	Student confirmation required
Microsoft Learn account	You can sign in and access the assigned collection or modules.
Azure portal access	You can access the correct Azure tenant/subscription or approved demo environment.
Microsoft Defender for Cloud	You can open Defender for Cloud and view environment settings, recommendations, Secure Score, and assigned resources where applicable.
Microsoft Defender portal	You can access assigned incident, alert, or Defender XDR views if the assessment includes operational review.
Named user account	You are using your assigned account, not a shared administrator account.
MFA	Your MFA method works and you can complete sign-in without assistance.
Browser and screenshots	You have a modern browser and can capture clear screenshots for evidence.
LMS / Teams / GitHub access	You know where to download assessment files and where to submit deliverables.

Access blocker rule

If you cannot access the required portal, tenant, subscription, resource group, or LMS area, notify the instructor immediately. Do not attempt to bypass access controls or use another student account.

4. Assessment Rules and Conduct

- **Work only in approved scope.** Use the lab subscription, resource group, tenant, demo environment, or customer environment explicitly assigned by the instructor.
- **Use least privilege.** Do not request or use Global Administrator access unless the instructor and customer have explicitly approved it for a controlled scenario.
- **No production changes without approval.** Do not enable paid plans, deploy extensions, modify policies, change access, or remediate production workloads unless the instructor confirms written authorization.
- **No sensitive data.** Do not upload or enter real customer data, personal data, HR data, financial records, secrets, keys, tokens, source code, confidential prompts, or proprietary information.
- **No destructive testing.** Do not run malware, exploit tools, vulnerability scanners, stress tests, denial-of-service tests, or suspicious payloads unless explicitly included in a sandboxed instructor lab.
- **Respect auditability.** Use your own named account. Evidence must be traceable to your assigned student identity or lab group.
- **Maintain professional language.** Assessment submissions must be clear, respectful, and suitable for enterprise review.

5. Permitted and Prohibited Resources

Permitted	Not permitted unless explicitly authorized
Course slides, student guide, lab guide, Microsoft Learn modules, Microsoft Docs/Learn references, instructor demonstrations, and your own lab notes.	Copying another student's answers, using an answer key, using hidden instructor materials, accessing unauthorized tenants/subscriptions, or submitting generated content without review and attribution.
AI tools may be used for study, revision, formatting assistance, and explanation if the instructor allows them.	Using AI tools to produce final answers without understanding, validation, and disclosure where required by the provider's academic-integrity policy.
Screenshots from approved lab or demo environments.	Screenshots from unrelated client environments, production systems outside scope, or environments containing confidential data.

6. Knowledge Assessment Instructions

The knowledge assessment checks whether you understand the core concepts covered in the workshop. Read each question carefully and answer based on the scenario, not only on keyword recognition.

Question type	How to answer
Multiple choice / multiple response	Select the best answer or all correct answers as instructed. If a question says "choose two," choose

	exactly two.
Matching	Match the security concept, tool, role, or control to the correct description.
Short answer	Use concise technical language. Explain the reason for your answer, not only the final recommendation.
Scenario decision	Identify the risk, affected control area, recommended action, and operational consideration.

- Do not leave short-answer fields blank. If you are unsure, state your assumption and answer with the best security rationale you can provide.
- Use Microsoft terminology accurately: for example, Microsoft Entra ID, Microsoft Defender for Cloud, CSPM, CWPP, Defender XDR, Secure Score, recommendations, attack paths, workload protection plans, and Conditional Access.
- Where a question asks for a recommendation, include the business or risk reason behind the recommendation.

7. Practical Lab Evidence Instructions

The practical component evaluates whether you can safely navigate cloud security tooling, interpret findings, document evidence, and recommend remediation. Evidence quality matters: unclear screenshots, missing context, or unsupported claims may lose marks.

Evidence area	Minimum evidence expected
Environment context	Course code, student name or group ID, tenant or lab environment name, subscription/resource group where appropriate, and date/time of evidence capture.
CSPM / posture	Screenshot or notes showing Secure Score, recommendations, resource inventory, regulatory compliance, or posture findings.
Misconfiguration or risk finding	Identify one security finding, affected resource or scope, risk impact, and recommended mitigation.
Workload protection	Evidence related to selected Defender workload modules such as Storage, Containers, App Service, or AI Services, depending on the class path.
Remediation or plan	Show the completed remediation, assigned policy, enabled plan, validated recommendation, or a written remediation plan if the lab is observation-only.

Operational review	Summarize what changed, what should be monitored, residual risk, and any cleanup or rollback required.
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8. Screenshot and Evidence Standards

- Screenshots must be readable at normal zoom and must show enough page context for the instructor to verify where the evidence was captured.
- Each screenshot must include a short caption explaining what it proves.
- Do not submit screenshots with visible secrets, keys, tokens, passwords, personal data, confidential customer data, or proprietary prompts.
- If subscription IDs, tenant IDs, object IDs, or user details are sensitive in your environment, mask or crop them before submission unless the instructor requires them for verification.
- For group work, list all group members and identify who captured or validated each evidence item.
- Use original screenshots. Do not fabricate portal evidence or edit screenshots in a way that changes their meaning.

Recommended evidence file name	Example
<course>_<student>_<component>_<sequence>.png	CESE323_AlexM_CSPM_01.png
<course>_<student>_<assessment>.docx/pdf	CESE323_AlexM_AssessmentSubmission.pdf
<course>_<group>_<lab>_<date>.zip	CESE323_Group03_LabEvidence_2026-05-25.zip

9. Scenario Analysis Instructions

Scenario analysis questions require applied security reasoning. Use the structure below unless the question gives a different format.

Response section	What to include
1. Situation summary	One or two sentences describing the environment, workload, risk, or incident.
2. Security concern	Identify the main risk: misconfiguration, identity exposure, compliance gap, workload threat, data leakage, prompt injection, unmanaged asset, or operational blind spot.
3. Affected services	Name the relevant Microsoft services, for example Defender for Cloud, Defender XDR, Microsoft Entra ID, Microsoft Purview, Azure Policy, Azure Arc, AKS, Storage, App Service, or AI/Foundry resources.

4. Recommended action	Describe the recommended control, remediation, policy assignment, workload protection plan, monitoring step, or governance action.
5. Business justification	Explain how the action reduces risk, improves visibility, supports compliance, or improves operational readiness.
6. Safe implementation note	Mention scope, approval, rollback, cost, least privilege, or data-handling concerns where relevant.

10. Practical Module Selection

The workshop allows the instructor or customer to select two workload-protection focus areas. Your practical evidence must match the modules selected for your class.

Selected module	Typical assessment evidence
Defender for Storage	Storage account or blob scenario, Defender for Storage configuration, malware/suspicious access discussion, storage-related recommendation, and data-handling controls.
Defender for Containers	AKS/container security posture, registry or cluster findings, Defender for Containers enablement or observation, and remediation plan.
Defender for App Service	App Service posture, runtime protection considerations, diagnostics/logging, and app workload security recommendations.
Defender for AI Services / Microsoft Foundry	AI workload posture, Defender AI plan or dashboard evidence, identity/access controls, prompt/data leakage risks, and safe AI operations guidance.

Demo-only environments

If the environment is demo-only or observation-only, submit screenshots from the instructor-approved demo and replace configuration evidence with written implementation steps, expected outcomes, risks, and rollback considerations.

11. Live Environment and Customer Tenant Rules

Some CESE323 deliveries may include live environment review. This is a controlled operational activity, not an open lab. Students must follow the instructor's scope exactly.

- Do not activate Defender plans in a customer subscription unless written approval is confirmed by the instructor or customer owner.
- Do not change policy assignments, role assignments, diagnostic settings, connectors, agent configuration, or workload plans unless the task explicitly instructs you to do so.
- Capture evidence only from approved screens and avoid exposing sensitive tenant data in submissions.
- Use the change window, rollback plan, and cleanup instructions provided for the class.
- If a finding appears severe or production-impacting, notify the instructor instead of attempting unsupervised remediation.

12. Submission Requirements

Submission item	Required format
Knowledge assessment	Completed in LMS, Microsoft Forms, printable answer sheet, or platform specified by the instructor.
Practical lab evidence	PDF, DOCX, or ZIP file containing screenshots and short explanations. Follow the naming convention provided by the instructor.
Scenario analysis	Written response in LMS, DOCX, PDF, or assessment booklet. Use headings and concise technical language.
Reflection and cleanup confirmation	Short written statement or checklist confirming what was learned, what was changed, and whether cleanup/rollback was completed.
Student declaration	Signed or acknowledged declaration confirming the work is your own and was completed in approved scope.

- Submit before the due date stated by the instructor or LMS.
- Keep a backup copy of your evidence until final results are issued.
- Do not submit compressed files containing executables, scripts, malware samples, keys, tokens, or exported customer data unless specifically required by a controlled lab and approved by the instructor.
- If the LMS upload fails, notify the instructor immediately and provide evidence of the issue.

13. Marking Criteria

Criterion	What markers look for
Technical accuracy	Correct use of Microsoft cloud security terminology, accurate interpretation of tools and controls, and sound recommendations.
Risk reasoning	Clear explanation of threat, impact, likelihood, affected asset, control gap, and remediation priority.
Evidence quality	Readable screenshots, relevant context, captions, and traceability to the assigned lab scope.
Operational discipline	Least privilege, change control, scope control, safe data handling, cleanup, and rollback awareness.
Communication quality	Professional structure, concise writing, clear assumptions, and actionable recommendations.

14. Resubmission and Remediation

- Students who do not meet the required threshold may be allowed one resubmission, subject to instructor or provider policy.
- A resubmission must address the specific feedback given by the instructor. Do not resubmit the same evidence without correction.
- Late submissions may be capped or rejected depending on the course policy announced by the training provider.
- If access or lab failure prevented completion, the instructor may authorize alternative evidence such as annotated screenshots from a demo environment or a written implementation plan.

15. Technical Issues During Assessment

Issue	What to do
Portal access failure	Capture the error message if safe, note the time, and notify the instructor. Do not use another student's account.
Permission denied	Record the task, affected resource, required permission, and error message. Submit the blocker with your reasoning if the instructor cannot resolve it in time.
Resource unavailable	Use the instructor-approved fallback, demo environment, or written remediation plan.
Unexpected production warning	Stop and ask the instructor before proceeding.

Billing or paid plan warning	Do not continue until approval is confirmed.
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16. Student Declaration

By submitting the assessment, I confirm that:

- The submitted work is my own or clearly identifies approved group contributors.
- I used only approved environments, resources, and assistance.
- I did not include confidential data, secrets, keys, tokens, or unauthorized customer information.
- I followed the instructor's scope, safety instructions, and cleanup requirements.
- I understand that unsafe or unauthorized activity may result in the practical component being marked not yet competent.

Student name	Signature / acknowledgement	Date

Appendix A - Student Assessment Checklist

Use this checklist before final submission.

	Checklist item
☐	I confirmed my name, course code, class date, and group number are included.
☐	I completed the knowledge assessment.
☐	I included required practical evidence for the selected workload modules.
☐	My screenshots are readable and include captions.
☐	I explained at least one risk, recommendation, and remediation or mitigation path.
☐	I did not include secrets, credentials, tokens, personal data, or confidential customer data.
☐	I documented any blockers such as missing permissions or unavailable resources.
☐	I confirmed cleanup, rollback, or no-change status where required.
☐	I checked file names and uploaded the correct version.
☐	I submitted before the deadline or notified the instructor of a technical issue.

Appendix B - Recommended Submission Cover Page

Field	Student entry
Student name	
Student email / ID	
Course code	CESE323 ERC1.0
Course title	Cloud Security Envisioning & Strategy
Class date	
Instructor	
Lab model	Dedicated student subscription / shared training subscription / customer live subscription / demo-only environment

Selected workload modules	Storage / Containers / App Service / AI Services
Submission files included	
Declaration acknowledged	Yes / No

Appendix C - Source Alignment for Courseware Review

This instruction document is aligned to the CESE323 workshop design and lab-readiness requirements, including:

- Strategic Initiation and Governance: goals, priorities, security requirements, risk vectors, architecture overview, and gap analysis.
- Configuration Control and Workload Protection: Defender portal, CSPM, attack paths, over-privileged identities, and selected Defender workload modules.
- Practical Implementation and Remediation: policy assignment, AI-specific security, data leakage, prompt injection, and remediation blockers.
- Hands-on Scenarios and Live Environment Review: scenario demonstrations, threat mapping, Defender for Cloud activation, tailored operational examples, and live-environment safeguards.
- Student readiness controls: named accounts, MFA, Azure/Defender portal access, lab permissions, cost approval, workload prerequisites, screenshot tools, and cleanup requirements.

Appendix D - Quick Student Reminder

Before submitting

Your assessment should prove three things: you understand the security concept, you can apply it safely in the assigned environment, and you can communicate the risk and remediation clearly enough for an enterprise security team to act on it.